Note that we've written this code as a config hook. In fact, RSpec.configure is the *only* place :suite hooks are allowed, because they exist independently of any examples or groups.

You can use before and after hooks with any of the three scopes. As we write this chapter, around hooks only support :example scope.

What about before(:each) and before(:all)?

You may occasionally run across some specs that define their hooks using :each and :all for the scope argument. These are the terms RSpec originally used instead of :example and :context. However, we found that :all was confusing when used to define config hooks:

```
RSpec.configure do |config|
  config.before(:all) do
    # ...
  end
end
```

In this configuration file, the word "all" suggests the hook will run before *all* the examples in the entire suite—but that's not the case. This hook will run once per top-level *example group*. To run once for the suite, you'd use before(:suite) instead.

RSpec 3 fixed the confusing wording by renaming :each to :example and :all to :context. The old names :each and :all are still there for backward compatibility with existing specs, but we recommend using only the newer terms.

One last thing to note about hooks: If you have one example group nested inside another, your hooks will run in the following order:

- before hooks run from the outside in.
- after hooks run from the inside out.

around hooks behave similarly. The beginning of each around hook—the bits before the call to example.run—will run outside-in, just like a before hook. The end of each around hook will run from the inside out.

When to Use Hooks

The hooks you've written have had two purposes:

- Removing duplicated or incidental details that would distract readers from the point of your example
- Expressing the English descriptions of your example groups as executable code